UNIT 1

Introduction of Political Science



1.1 Meaning, Definition and Origin of Political Science

Politics

What is Politics??!! I hear about it in tea-stalls, restaurants, buses and in all other places that I go to... I have been hearing this word since childhood... and everybody is so serious when they talk about it... so should I get to know what is politics?



The term 'Politics' is closely related to the Greek word 'Polis' meaning 'city-state' (for affairs of the cities-for affairs of the state). The study of politics dates back to 5th century BC(BCE) Greece with immense contributions by political philosophers ***Plato*** (428/427 BC – 348/347 BC) and ***Aristotle*** (384 BC- 322 BC). Before the 20th century, the study of politics was integrated with other disciplines such as history and philosophy.

Learning Objectives

- Provides insights into the meaning of Politics and the manner in which it affects the lives of people.
- Examines the definitions of Political Science and the changing nature of the discipline.
- Explains the scope of Political Science.
- Throws light on the various approaches to the study of Political Science.
- Discusses the relationship between Political Science and other Social Sciences.

Politics was primarily concerned with the study of ethics. It further focused on the study of political ideas, political institutions and processes within states and the relations between states. But the last two centuries witnessed the study of politics concentrating on the conflict between liberty and equality. In the 21st century, a central theme has been the constant conflict between liberty and security. Some other major themes that are not central to the study of politics are development, environmental sustainability, gender equality and international peace and co-operation.



POLITICS IS EVERYONE'S BUSINESS

All through history, political philosophers have different perspectives on the central theme of politics. The Greek philosopher ***Aristotle***, the father of Political Science, considered the study of

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